

Polynomial equations



1

a $x = \frac{4}{5}, -3, 2$

c $x = -3, 6, \frac{2}{5}$

e $x = 5$

g $x = -4, 4, 0$

b $x = -6, -4, 4$

d $x = 0, \frac{5}{3}$

f $x = -10, 5, 0$

h $x = 0, \frac{9}{8}, -\frac{9}{8}$

2

a $2x^3(x+20)(x-2) = 0$

b $x = 0, 2, -20$

3

a $(4x^2 - 5)(x - 3) = 0$

b $x = 3, \frac{\sqrt{5}}{2}, -\frac{\sqrt{5}}{2}$

4

a $(x - 5)(x^2 + 6x + 9) = 0$

b $x = -3$

Equations reducible to quadratics

5

a i $p = x^2$

ii $p = 9, 25$

iii $x = \pm 3, \pm 5$

b i $p = x^2$

ii $p = 1, 25$

iii $x = \pm 1, \pm 5$

c i $p = 5x^2$

ii $p = 4, 9$

iii $x = \pm \frac{2\sqrt{5}}{5}, \pm \frac{3\sqrt{5}}{5}$

d i $p = 9x^2$

ii $p = 4, 9$

iii $x = \pm 1, \pm \frac{2}{3}$

e i $p = 2x + 4$

ii $p = -2, -8$

iii $x = -3, -6$

f i $p = 3x + 3$

ii $p = -12, -9$

iii $x = -5, -4$

g

i $p = 4x + 8$

ii $p = -4, -12$

iii $x = -3, -5$



i $p = 4x - 4$

ii $p = 7, -9$

iii $x = \frac{11}{4}, -\frac{5}{4}$

6

a $x = \pm 1, \pm 2$

e $x = -4, -\frac{15}{4}$

b $x = \pm 2, \pm 4$

f $x = -\frac{3}{2}, -\frac{15}{8}$

c $x = \pm 5, \pm 2\sqrt{6}$

g $x = -\frac{34}{27}, -\frac{5}{3}$

d $x = \pm 5, \pm 3$

h $x = \frac{3}{16}, -\frac{1}{4}$

7

a $x = \pm 3$

e $x = \pm\sqrt{7}$

b $x = \pm 2$

f $x = \pm\sqrt{15}$

c $x = \pm 4$

g $x = \pm\sqrt{14}$

d $x = \pm 5$

h $x = \pm 1$

Applications

8

a Any expression equivalent to $4x^3 - 80x^2 + 300x$.

b $x = 4$

9

a $P = x^3 - 7x^2 - 11x + 9$

b $x = 37$

10



a Answers may vary.

Taking out the central rectangular prism leaves behind a triangular prism of length $23x + 10 - 3x$, height $2x$, and width $2x + 6$.

Putting this together, we have

$$\frac{2x(23x + 10 - 3x)}{2}(2x + 6) = 240$$

which we can simplify to

$$x(2x + 1)(x + 3) = 12$$

b We can rewrite the equation as

$$2x^3 + 7x^2 + 3x - 12 = 0$$

Using long division or otherwise we can factor this into the form:

$$(x - 1)(2x^2 + 9x + 12) = 0$$

The first factor gives the solution $x = 1$, while the second factor has two complex solutions. Since x represents a length (in feet), it must be that $x = 1$.

So the dimensions are as follows:

- The width of the ramp is 8 feet
- The height of the ramp is 2 feet
- The total length of the ramp is 33 feet
- The flat distance between the two sloped sections is 3 feet
- The horizontal length of the shorter sloped section is 12 feet
- The horizontal length of the longer sloped section is 18 feet